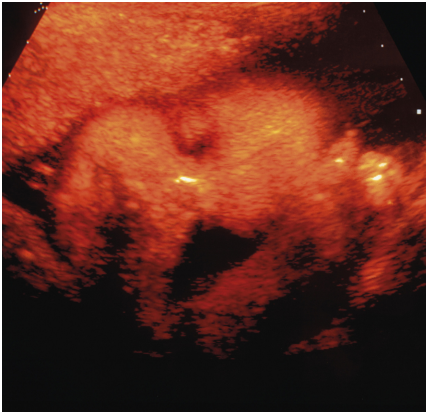




YOU ARE **39 WEEKS AND 6 DAYS**
1 day to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

It's been wonderful to see your baby's progress and facial features as each day of the pregnancy has passed by. 2-D and 3-D ultrasound images, as well as MRI, have all played a part in giving us a glimpse into the fascinating and complex world of life before birth.

“For most women, it is safe to go past your due date, but you should speak with your doctor about your options.”

If you are deemed to be at a higher risk of complications, you may be offered an induction of labor at or after 39 weeks.

High-risk factors include being 40 or over, having a big or small baby, and a previous birth complicated by [shoulder dystocia](#). The option of have a Cesarean delivery will also be discussed, depending on the severity of the problem.

At this stage, some women begin to try natural ways to trigger labor, with varying degrees of effectiveness, one of which is drink raspberry leaf tea.

Not to be confused with raspberry tea, it has been used for many years to stimulate labor. Some small studies have demonstrated that pregnant women experience a shorter second stage of labor after drinking raspberry leaf tea. Drinking this tea after 37 weeks is not likely to be harmful.

Some added benefits to raspberry leaf tea include nutrition as it contains vitamins A, C, E, and B, and the minerals calcium, magnesium, and iron, all of which are required for a healthy pregnancy.

Drunk after the birth, raspberry leaf tea can help the uterus to contract to its pre-pregnancy size, and also encourage the flow of breast milk.

ASK A DOCTOR

What exactly is a “[show](#)”? During pregnancy, a plug of jellylike mucus seals the lower end of your cervix and this prevents infection from getting into your uterus. This “plug” comes away toward the end of pregnancy—known as a “bloody show”—and although this can mean that labor is going to start soon, it can also dislodge up to six weeks before your labor actually starts.

TAKE A “BABYMOON”

Consider now whether you might want to take a “babymoon” once the baby is born. Getting to know your newborn can be difficult if there's a constant stream of visitors. A “babymoon” allows you to shut out the world and spend a few days home alone. Your newborn baby will sleep